

LETTERS FROM BELLAMY STREET

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Genre: Historical Romance

Manuscript: 84,000 words

Original Manuscript — Before Editing

Clara had always hated the rain.

It reminded her of the day her father died and now she was standing outside the house waiting for Mr. Whitmore to arrive. She wasn't sure why she agreed to marry him because she didn't love him but her family needed money and that was the reason.

The carriage arrived late and Clara looked at it.

Mr. Whitmore came out.

"You look beautiful," he said.

"Thank you."

He smiled.

"I hope you're ready for the wedding."

Clara looked away because she didn't want to tell him that she was thinking about someone else.

His name was Thomas.

She hadn't seen him in five years.

But she still remembered him.

Editing Issues Identified

- Repetitive sentence structures.
- Emotional moments were explained instead of developed.
- Clara's motivation needed greater depth.
- Dialogue lacked subtext.
- The romantic conflict needed stronger tension.
- Historical atmosphere was too limited.

Editing Work

I strengthened the prose, varied sentence rhythm, developed Clara's internal conflict, and introduced more period atmosphere without changing the author's core story.

Edited Manuscript — After Editing

Clara Bellamy had learned to hate rain.

It had rained the morning her father died, turning Bellamy Street into a ribbon of mud and making the black carriage wheels sink beneath the weight of the afternoon.

Five years later, the rain had returned.

So had the memory.

Clara stood beneath the stone archway of her family's house, watching droplets gather along the iron railing.

Her mother's voice drifted from somewhere behind her.

"He's late."

Clara didn't answer.

She knew who she meant.

Lord Whitmore.

Her future husband.

The man who would save the Bellamy estate from debt.

The man she did not love.

A carriage finally appeared at the end of the street.

Clara straightened her gloves.

"Remember why you're doing this," her mother whispered.

Clara looked toward the road.

She tried to remember.

Money.

The house.

Her family's future.

Those were the reasons.

They were supposed to be enough.

The carriage stopped.

Lord Whitmore stepped down.

"Miss Bellamy."

"Lord Whitmore."

He smiled.

"You look beautiful."

Clara lowered her eyes.

"Thank you."

His smile widened.

"I hope you're ready for the wedding."

She looked past him toward the rain.

For one foolish second, she imagined another carriage.

Another man.

A different life.

Thomas.

Five years had passed since he left Bellamy Street.

Five years since he had promised to return.

Five years since Clara had stopped waiting.

At least, that was what she told herself.

Lord Whitmore offered his arm.

Clara accepted it.

But as they walked toward the house, she looked once over her shoulder.

At the far end of the street, a man stood beneath an umbrella.

He was watching her.

And Clara knew him immediately.

Thomas had come home.